

TAB 28



Board of Education Report

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Ms. Newbill - Celebration of Black History Month 2026 (Res-031-25/26) (For Action January 27, 2026)

Whereas, Black History Month, or National African American History Month, is an annual celebration of achievements by Black Americans and a time for recognizing the central role of African Americans in United States history;

Whereas, Black History Month 2026 is a celebration of the 100-year legacy of Dr. Carter G. Woodson, whose establishment of Negro History Week in 1926 laid the foundation for what would become Black History Month, a cornerstone of historical education and cultural reflection in the United States;

Whereas, Dr. Carter G. Woodson, a Harvard trained historian, like W.E.B. DuBois before him, believed that truth would not be denied and that reason would prevail over prejudice;

Whereas, Every United States President has officially designated the month of February as Black History Month and other countries around the world, including Canada and the United Kingdom, also devote a month to celebrating Black history;

Whereas, Established by Dr. Carter G. Woodson in 1915, the Association for the Study of African American Life and History (ASALH) strives to promote, research, preserve, interpret, and disseminate information about Black life, history, and culture to the global community.

Whereas, Black History Month 2026 marks the centennial celebration of organized efforts to recognize, preserve, and honor the history, culture, and achievements of Black Americans, reflected in the 2026 ASALH theme, "*A Century of Black History Commemorations*";

Whereas, For a century, Black History commemorations have illuminated the resilience, innovation, leadership, and contributions of Black Americans in fields such as education, science, the arts, business, civil rights, government, technology, and public service;

Whereas, For the past century, spanning major milestones such as the Harlem Renaissance, the Civil Rights Movement, the Voting Rights Act of 1965, and continuing through the cultural, political, and educational advancements of the 21st century, Black History commemorations have played a vital role in elevating Black voices, honoring Black achievements, and deepening America's understanding of its own history;

Whereas, The centennial theme honors the work of generations of educators, scholars, activists, students, and community organizations who have advanced the study and preservation of Black history, ensuring that the richness of Black experiences is included in the national narrative;

Whereas, Black History Month serves as an essential opportunity to uplift stories that have historically been overlooked or underrepresented, fostering a deeper understanding of the shaping of American democracy,

culture, and identity;

Whereas, Recognizing this centennial milestone reinforces the importance of continuing to expand culturally responsive education, support inclusive curriculum, and ensure that all students learn about and appreciate the diverse histories that enrich our society;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is committed to culturally responsive, inclusive, and historically accurate instruction that reflects the diversity of its students and honors the contributions of Black Americans;

Whereas, The Black Student Achievement Plan (BSAP) provides targeted academic, social-emotional, and community support to address opportunity gaps, promote equity, and improve outcomes for Black students across the District;

Whereas, The District has strengthened its African American History and Ethnic Studies curriculum, ensuring students have access to comprehensive instruction on African civilizations, the African diaspora, the struggle for civil rights, and the ongoing pursuit of justice and empowerment for historically marginalized communities, encouraging students to think critically about social justice, civic engagement, and shared responsibility;

Whereas, Black History Month serves as a reaffirmation of the District's commitment to anti-racism, educational equity, and the creation of learning environments where every student feels seen, valued, and empowered;

Whereas, Honoring a century of Black history commemorations underscores the importance of ensuring that future generations continue to learn about the diverse, complex, and foundational contributions of Black Americans from 1926 to 2026 and beyond while recognizing the ongoing work necessary to protect civil rights, expand educational opportunity, and advance justice and equity for all students; and

Whereas, Our democracy's founding ideals were exclusionary when they were written, but Black Americans have continuously fought to make them true; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District recognizes February as National Black History Month;

Resolved further, That the Board acknowledges that all people of the United States are beneficiaries of the wealth of history given to all by Black Culture, Black Inventors, Black Artists, Black Artisans, Black Advocacy Black Leaders, Black Civic Engagement, and Black workers;

Resolved, further, That the Board commits to the inclusion of Black History into the core curriculum, including, but not limited to Ethnic Studies, African American History, and African American Literature, as well as encourages strong integration across coursework in History, English Language Arts, Science, Mathematics, and Arts so that this critical learning lives in the minds of our students beyond the month of February;

Resolved further, That the Board direct the Superintendent to expand upon the District's existing efforts, such as the Black Student Achievement Plan, to continue to identify strategies and tactics to align resources targeted toward eliminating anti-racist educational practices and closing the gap of academic achievement outcomes for Black Students;

Resolved further, That the District will continue to address challenges unique to Black students and families and recognize the Black Lives Matter at Schools Week of Action (February 2-6, 2026). This national week of action includes a variety of activities focused on social justice in education, such as curriculum fairs, community-building events, and workshops designed to support and empower Black students, families and educators; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Superintendent will work with educators, librarians, all the schools of the District, and our wider community to recognize and celebrate this month, and throughout the academic year, with culturally relevant and appropriate curriculum, programs, ceremonies, and activities that generate in-depth discussion of the complex factual history of the United States and the legacy of Black Americans.